Prompt (resident): Make me a guide: hurricane preparation for renters in Lee County

Hurricane Preparation Guide for Renters in Lee County

Living in a rental property in Lee County requires proactive communication with your landlord and a clear understanding of your specific evacuation zone. This guide outlines the essential steps to protect yourself, your belongings, and your legal rights during hurricane season.

1. Know Your Risks and Rights

- **Identify your zone:** Visit the Lee County Evacuation Zone Map to see if you are in a mandatory evacuation area.
- **Review your lease:** Check your lease agreement for clauses regarding storm preparation, window protection (shutters), and renter's insurance requirements.
- **Get Renter's Insurance:** Landlord insurance **does not** cover your personal belongings. Ensure you have a policy that includes flood coverage, as standard policies often exclude it.

2. Pre-Storm Checklist

- ☐ **Document everything:** Take photos or videos of every room and all personal belongings for insurance purposes.
- ☐ **Communicate with your landlord:** Ask if the property has hurricane shutters and who is responsible for installing them. If you are responsible, ensure you know how to operate them.
- ☐ **Secure outdoor items:** If you have a patio or balcony, you are responsible for bringing all furniture, plants, and decor inside before a storm.
- ☐ **Emergency Kit:** Prepare a "Go-Bag" with important documents (lease, insurance policy, ID, medical records) in a waterproof container.
- ☐ **Sign up for alerts:** Register for AlertLee to receive emergency notifications via text, email, or phone.

3. During and After the Storm

1. **Follow evacuation orders:** If your zone is ordered to evacuate, leave immediately. Do not stay in a rental unit that is not structurally sound or is in a flood-prone area.
2. **Report damage:** If the property is damaged, notify your landlord in writing as soon as it is safe to do so. Take photos of the damage before any cleanup begins.
3. **Document repairs:** Keep a log of all communications with your landlord regarding repairs and save receipts for any emergency supplies or temporary housing costs.

Key contacts & links

- **Lee County Emergency Management:** The primary source for official storm information, evacuation orders, and shelter openings.
- **AlertLee:** Official emergency notification system for Lee County.

- **Lee County All Hazards Guide:** A comprehensive PDF resource for all emergency planning.

Sources

- Lee County Hurricane Preparation
- Lee County Plan & Prepare
- Lee County All Hazards Guide (2026)

Note: Always prioritize official guidance from Lee County Emergency Management during an active weather event. If you are in immediate danger, call 911.

Helpful resources

- Hurricane Preparation Guide - Lee County Southwest Florida: The official Lee County hurricane portal provides the most accurate and up-to-date information for residents.
- PDF Lee County , Florida ALL HAZARDS GUIDE: The All Hazards Guide is a comprehensive document covering everything from evacuation routes to emergency supply lists.
- Plan & Prepare | Lee County , FL: Provides practical steps for developing a family emergency plan tailored to the specific hazards of Lee County.

You might also ask

- How do I find out which evacuation zone my specific apartment complex is in?
- What should I do if my landlord refuses to install hurricane shutters?
- Are there specific pet-friendly shelters in Lee County if I have to evacuate?

▶ Agent steps
